Draft - expert review pending

Note: This unit is complete and passes the platform's automated checks, but it is not reviewed yet. So, treat its sources and claims with care. You are encouraged to report errors and provide feedback.

Draft translation - not yet human-reviewed / مسوده ترجمه

Creating and Maintaining Reflective Journals

This is the unit where the course's assessed work actually happens. The guide's *reflection file* (10 marks) is a reflective journal kept across the term against the prompts and standards this unit teaches. Everything before this point - the logic of Units 1 to 3, the reflective process of Units 4 and 5 - was preparation for it. Everything in this point is about doing it well enough to be assessed and, more importantly, well enough to be useful.

A journal is not a diary. A diary records what happened. A journal examines what happened, analyses why, and draws a finding that can be carried forward. The difference is the same one this course has been drawing since Unit 1: description is not analysis, and analysis without evidence is assumption. This unit makes that difference concrete in the form you will actually submit.

Unit learning outcomes

By the end of this unit you will be able to:

1. Explain what a reflective journal is for and distinguish it from a diary, a lesson plan and a scheme of work.
2. Create a journal with a structure that supports sustained reflection across a term, and name what keeps it alive past the first two weeks.

3. Write a journal entry that moves from description to analysis and reaches at least the contextual level of reflection.
4. Use a set of prompts to start and deepen entries when the writing does not come easily.
5. Draw the course together: explain how the logic of Units 1 to 3 and the practice of Units 4 to 6 are one course, not two.

Prerequisite knowledge

Units 4 and 5 in full. A journal is the instrument of a reflective practice, so the practice comes first. Unit 1's standards return here as the test of whether an entry reasons or merely recounts.

In this unit

1. What a journal is for - the purpose of a reflective journal and what it is not.
2. Creating one, and keeping it alive - structure, routines and the reasons journals die.
3. Writing to reflect on your teaching - what distinguishes reflective writing from descriptive writing, with examples at three levels.
4. Prompts, and drawing the course together - prompts for starting and deepening entries, and a course-level synthesis.

How to use this unit

Topic 6.1 to 6.3 are about the journal itself: what it is, how to keep it, how to write in it. Topic 6.4 has two halves: the first gives you prompts you can use for your assessed file, the second draws the whole course together. If

you are keeping the assessed reflection file, Topics 6.2 and 6.3 are the ones to study most carefully, because they are about the standard your journal will be marked against.

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